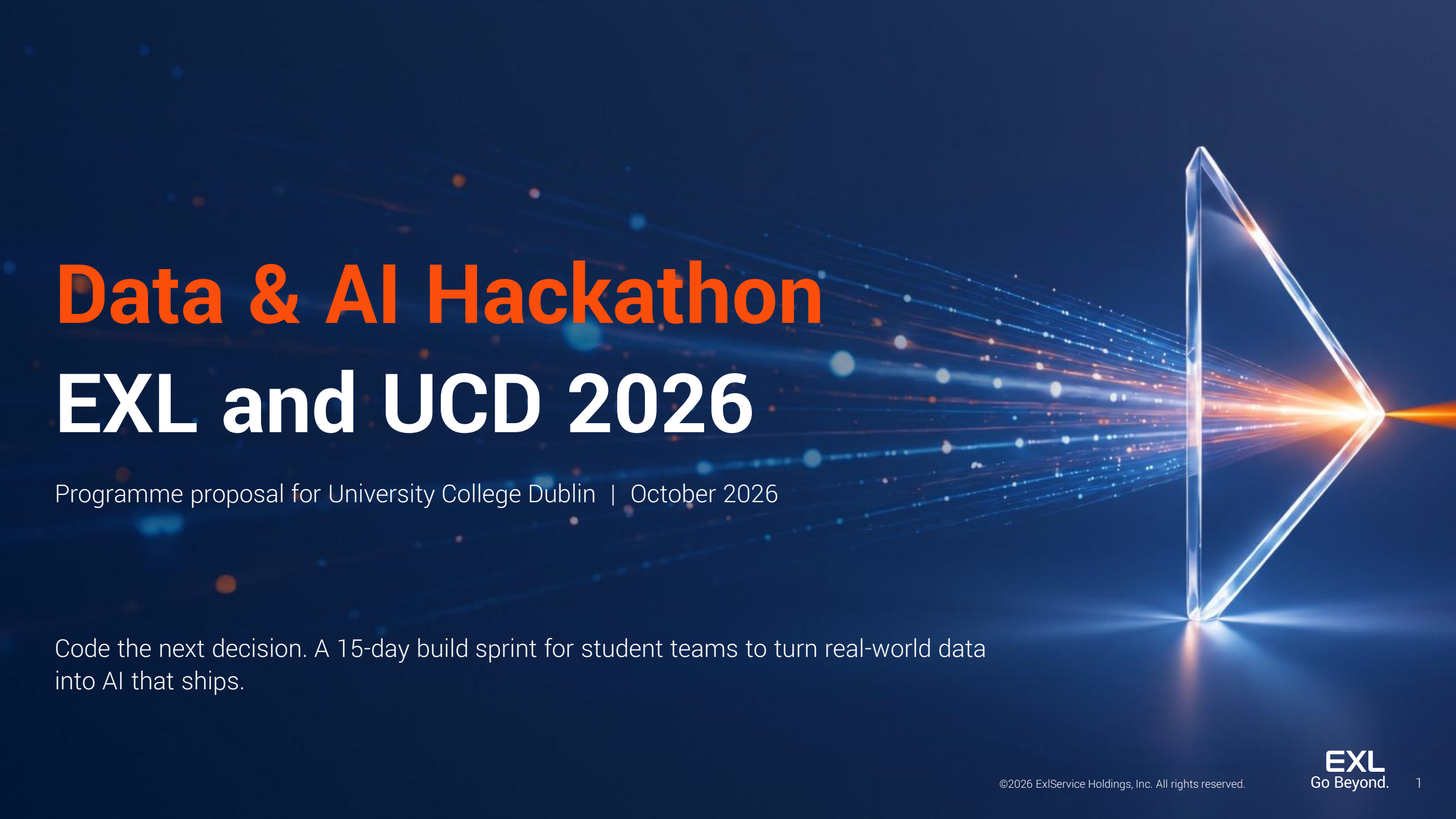
Data & AI Hackathon

EXL and UCD 2026

Programme proposal for University College Dublin | October 2026

Code the next decision. A 15-day build sprint for student teams to turn real-world data into AI that ships.



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EXL
Go Beyond.

Agenda

EXL Data & AI Hackathon 2026 with UCD

01 Overview and who can participate

02 Tracks and business challenges

03 Timeline, roadmap and finale day

04 Submissions, judging and rewards

05 FAQs, roles and next steps

Code the next decision

> DATA + AI HACKATHON · EXL × UCD

EXL works with leading insurers, healthcare organisations and banks on their hardest data and AI problems. The EXL Data & AI Hackathon brings a selection of those problems to UCD students.

The premise is simple. Pick a real business challenge, form a team and spend 15 days designing and building a solution. EXL leaders review every submission.

Eight finalist teams then present in-person to an EXL jury on 23 November, and the top three teams are rewarded.

2–4
students per team

15
days to build

4
real business challenges

8
finalist teams

Top 3
teams rewarded

23 Nov
in-person grand finale

REAL DATA. REAL CHALLENGES. REAL IMPACT.

Who can participate

Open to UCD students who want to solve real client problems with data and AI

Undergraduates

Bring fresh thinking from computer science, engineering, data science, business or any other discipline.

Postgraduates

MSc and PhD students can apply advanced AI, machine learning and data engineering skills to problems EXL is solving for clients today.

Mixed-skill teams

Combine technical, domain and design skills. The strongest entries pair sound engineering with a clear business case.

Eligibility at a glance

- **UCD students**
- **Teams of 2–4**
- **UCD email sign-up**
- **One entry per team**
- **Finale in person**

Four tracks, four real business challenges

Each team picks one challenge. Every challenge draws on more than one track.

		GenAI & Agents	Predictive Analytics	Data Engineering	Responsible AI
01	**Agentic healthcare integration** Global healthcare client · ~45 hybrid systems	●		●	○
02	**Agentic Power Platform migration** Large UK insurer · ~30 Power Platform apps	●		○	○
03	**Agentic data platform modernisation** UK and Ireland insurer · ~1,200 ETL jobs, 400+ SAS programs	●		●	○
04	**Agentic model risk factory** Tier-1 UK retail bank · ~250 production models	●	●	○	●

● Primary focus ○ Supporting

Challenge 01: Agentic healthcare integration

AI-native agentic integration fabric for a hybrid healthcare landscape

THE PROBLEM

A global healthcare client runs about 45 on-premise and cloud systems. Only about a quarter expose usable APIs, and even those need rework. Hand-building the other 30+ integrations is slow, inconsistent and costly.

45	~25%	3–5 mo
systems in a hybrid estate	with usable APIs	client delivery window

STARTER DATA & TOOLS

Synthea synthetic FHIR patient data, the public HL7 FHIR spec and mock systems you build. Azure and .NET Core preferred.

What your team builds

- Integrate 3–5 mock systems, such as a REST API, a legacy SQL database and an HL7 v2 or flat-file feed
- Use AI agents to discover each system, choose an integration pattern and generate the code
- Show the time and consistency gained versus hand-built integrations

Suggested approach

optional hints; humans review at each gate

1	**Discover**	Scan schemas, docs and logs; map dependencies
2	**Design**	Draft FHIR-aligned models and OpenAPI specs
3	**Generate**	Produce .NET APIs, adapters, tests and CI/CD
4	**Validate**	Contract, security and PHI checks with self-healing
5	**Operate**	API gateway, messaging, monitoring and alerts

Tracks GenAI & Agents | Data Engineering | Responsible AI

Based on a live EXL client challenge. Client figures are indicative; students work with synthetic data only.

Challenge 02: Agentic Power Platform migration

AI-native agentic migration factory: Power Platform apps to React, .NET Core and Azure

THE PROBLEM

A large UK insurer must move about 30 Power Platform apps to React/Node.js, .NET Core and NoSQL on Azure, linked to its admin platforms. The low-code logic is often undocumented and tied to Dataverse and Power Automate.

~30	FCA	2–3 mo
Power Platform apps	and GDPR rules apply	client delivery window

STARTER DATA & TOOLS

Synthetic Data and/or your own app on the free Power Apps Developer Plan.

What your team builds

- Migrate 1–2 sample Power Apps, including at least one Power Automate flow, to React, .NET Core and Cosmos DB
- Use AI agents to reverse-engineer business rules and generate specs, code and tests
- Prove behavioural parity between the original and the migrated app

Suggested approach

optional hints; humans review at each gate

1	**Analyse**	Parse Power Fx, Dataverse schemas and flows
2	**Design**	Specify React components, APIs and Cosmos DB models
3	**Generate**	Translate logic to TypeScript and C#; emit IaC
4	**Test**	Unit, API and UI tests plus side-by-side parity
5	**Integrate**	Wire to admin platforms, migrate data, monitor

Tracks GenAI & Agents | Data Engineering | Responsible AI

Based on a live EXL client challenge. Client figures are indicative; students work with sample or synthetic apps only.

Challenge 03: Agentic data platform modernisation

AI-native agentic migration factory: legacy ETL and SAS to an Azure lakehouse

THE PROBLEM

A large UK and Ireland insurer runs finance, actuarial and claims reporting on about 1,200 legacy ETL jobs and 400+ SAS programs. Logic is undocumented, lineage is unknown and every migrated pipeline must reconcile exactly with legacy outputs.

~1,200	400+	4–6 mo
legacy ETL jobs	SAS programs	client delivery window

STARTER DATA & TOOLS

Synthetic Data , or self-built T-SQL jobs on synthetic data. Databricks Free Edition or PySpark.

What your team builds

- Migrate 10–15 sample legacy jobs (T-SQL and SAS code) to PySpark
- Use AI agents to map column-level lineage, translate logic and generate tests
- Prove reconciliation: outputs match legacy record for record

Suggested approach

optional hints; humans review at each gate

1	**Discover**	Parse ETL, SAS and SQL code; build lineage and waves
2	**Design**	Map to bronze, silver and gold layers with data contracts
3	**Generate**	Translate logic to PySpark and Spark SQL with tests
4	**Reconcile**	Parallel-run diffs on counts, totals and records
5	**Operate**	Schedule, monitor SLAs and publish lineage

Tracks GenAI & Agents | Data Engineering | Responsible AI

Proposed challenge, subject to EXL confirmation. Client context is illustrative; students work with sample or synthetic data only.

Challenge 04: Agentic model risk factory

AI-native agentic factory to document, redevelop and validate a bank's model inventory

THE PROBLEM

A Tier-1 UK bank runs about 250 credit, fraud and pricing models built in SAS, R and Python. Under PRA SS1/23 each needs current documentation and independent validation, but documents are outdated and each validation takes 8–12 weeks.

~250	8–12	SS1/23
models in production	weeks per validation today	PRA model risk principles

STARTER DATA & TOOLS

Public credit-risk datasets (for example on Kaggle) and EXL sample model code (to be confirmed). Azure ML and MLflow preferred.

What your team builds

- Document 3–5 sample models and build their inventory records
- Use AI agents to rebuild one SAS or R model in Python, with parity proof
- Auto-generate a validation report on performance, stability and fairness

Suggested approach

optional hints; humans review at each gate

1	**Discover**	Scan code and documents; build the model inventory
2	**Document**	Reverse-engineer methodology, variables and limits
3	**Redevelop**	Re-implement SAS and R models in Python with tests
4	**Validate**	Back-test, calibrate, check stability and fairness
5	**Monitor**	Track drift and performance; trigger re-validation

Tracks GenAI & Agents | Predictive Analytics | Responsible AI

Proposed challenge, subject to EXL confirmation. Client context is illustrative; students work with public or synthetic data only.

Timeline

Fifteen days to build, one morning to win

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
28 Oct	**28 Oct – 3 Nov***	**28 Oct – 13 Nov**	**13 Nov**	**14 – 18 Nov**	**By 19 Nov**	**23 Nov**
Launch	**Registration and teams**	**Build sprint**	**Submission deadline**	**Pre-screening**	**Finalists announced**	**Grand finale**
Challenges released; registration opens	Register with UCD email; form teams of 2–4	15 days to design and build	Email your submission pack by 23:59*	EXL digital leaders score every entry	Eight teams confirmed to UCD	11:00–13:00, O'Connor Centre for Learning

The hackathon culminates in a live, in-person Grand Finale

23 November 2026 · 11:00 AM – 1:00 PM · O'Connor Centre for Learning

* Proposed – to be confirmed with UCD. All other dates as agreed with UCD.

Your roadmap to the finale

What a student team does, step by step

01 Register

Register with your UCD email address. You can register solo and join or form a team before registration closes.

02 Form a team

Build a team of 2–4 students and pick one of the four business challenges.

03 Build and submit

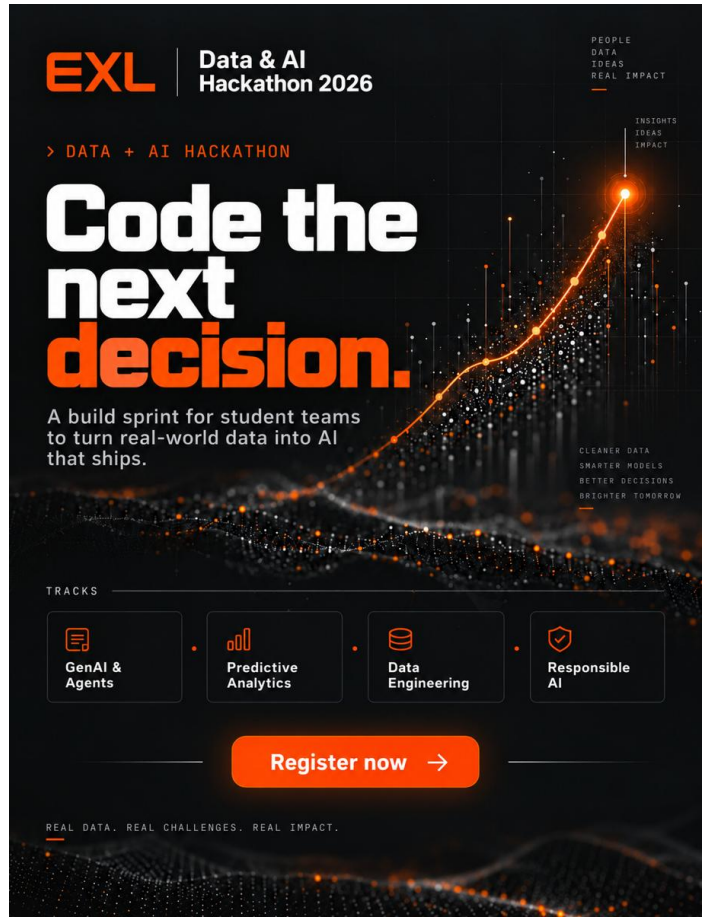
Design and build your solution over 15 days, then email your submission pack by 13 November.

04 Pre-screening

EXL digital leaders score every submission against the judging criteria and select eight finalists.

05 Grand finale

Finalists present live to the EXL jury on 23 November. The top three teams are announced on the day.



Student campaign poster (draft)

Grand finale: 23 November 2026

11:00 AM – 1:00 PM · O'Connor Centre for Learning · Eight finalist teams



10 min 11:00–11:10

EXL overview

Welcome, an introduction to EXL and how the morning runs.

80 min 11:10–12:30

Team presentations

Each finalist team has 10 minutes. Suggested split: 7-minute pitch, 3-minute live demo.

20 min 12:30–12:50

Jury Q&A

Judges question teams on approach, evidence and Responsible AI.

10 min 12:50–13:00

Final results

The jury confers; the top three teams are announced and awarded.

Jury

EXL leaders

In the room

Finalists, UCD faculty and guests

Venue needs (UCD)

Projector, screen, microphone and Wi-Fi

Submission requirements

One submission pack per team, emailed by 13 November

Solution deck

Up to 10 slides: problem, approach, architecture, results, Responsible AI and next steps.

Demo video

Up to 3 minutes showing the working prototype, shared as a link.

Code repository

GitHub or similar link with a README and setup steps.

Architecture diagram

One page showing components, data flows and AI models.

Responsible AI note

One page on data used, privacy, bias, limitations and safeguards.

How to submit

EMAIL TO

Monika.Rawal@exlservice.com

SUBJECT LINE

EXL Hackathon | Team name | Challenge 0X

DEADLINE

13 November 2026, 23:59 Irish time*

SEND FROM

A team member's UCD email address

- One challenge and one submission per team
- Public or synthetic data only; never personal data
- Declare AI tools and any existing code used

* Proposed cut-off time, to be confirmed. Requirements can be simplified with UCD if needed.

Judging criteria

One rubric for both rounds: pre-screening by EXL digital leaders and the finale jury

Business Impact	Addresses the client challenge with clear user benefits and a credible way to measure success.	**30%**
Technical approach	Uses appropriate data and AI methods. Demonstrates feasibility through sound reasoning, validation or a prototype where feasible.	**25%**
Innovation	Offers an original approach and explains how it improves on existing alternatives.	**20%**
Responsible AI	Addresses privacy, security and bias. Makes limitations and safeguards clear.	**15%**
Presentation & Q&A	Explains the solution clearly, supports claims with evidence and answers judges' questions.	**10%**

Score each criterion 1–5 and apply the weights; ties go to Business Impact.

Rewards and recognition

Prizes for the top three teams will be confirmed by EXL

2nd place

Prize to be confirmed

1st place

Prize to be confirmed

3rd place

Prize to be confirmed

For every finalist team

- **Certificate of recognition**
- **Present live to EXL leaders**
- **Considered for EXL internships***

* Internship consideration is at EXL's discretion and subject to standard hiring processes.

Frequently asked questions

Proposed answers for the student briefing pack

Q Who can take part?

Registered UCD undergraduate and postgraduate students from any discipline, in teams of 2–4.

Q Can I register without a team?

Yes. Register solo, then join or form a team before registration closes.

Q Do we need a working prototype?

Strongly encouraged. A well-reasoned design with a partial prototype can still score well.

Q Will we get real client data?

No. Challenges reflect real client problems but use public or synthetic data only. Never upload personal data.

Q Which tools can we use?

Any language or framework. Azure is preferred where named; free student tiers and open-source models are fine.

Q Can we use AI coding assistants?

Yes. State which tools you used and what they did in your submission.

Q Who owns what we build?

Ownership and usage terms will be set out in the hackathon terms and conditions agreed by EXL and UCD.

Q Where do we send questions?

Submissions go to Monika.Rawal@exlservice.com. A contact for questions will be shared at launch.

Roles and next steps

A low-effort, high-impact partnership with minimal UCD involvement

EXL provides

- Business challenges and starter guidance
- All communications and event materials
- Pre-screening by EXL digital leaders
- The jury, prizes and finale hosting

UCD provides

- Promotion to students through UCD channels
- Registrations from UCD email addresses
- The venue: O'Connor Centre for Learning, 23 Nov
- A faculty point of contact (optional)

Open items to confirm

1	Registration via UCD email and how registrations are shared	UCD
2	Registration close date (proposed 3 Nov)	UCD
3	Approve proposed challenges 03 and 04	EXL
4	Share suggested approaches with students, or problems only	EXL
5	Sample Power Apps package for Challenge 02	EXL
6	Prizes and jury panel	EXL
7	Room booking and AV for the finale	UCD

EXL

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Hackathon programme

EXL Academia Program

Data & AI Hackathon 2026

Business challenges

EXL digital leaders

Four live client-style challenges

Submissions

Monika Rawal

Monika.Rawal@exlservice.com

Thank you. We look forward to building with UCD.